

Filter Recommendations

What's in tap water and air, how to read your report, which filter handles what, purifiers, testing and setup · Module 5, Training 6

Step one: find out

- **US:** search "[your town] Consumer Confidence Report" (annual, required by law); EWG Tap Water Database by zip code.
- **Elsewhere:** your water utility's annual quality report (most publish one).
- **Well water:** test yearly via your local health department.
- **Radon:** an inexpensive home test kit; results in days. High → professional ventilation system.
- **Lead:** home test kits exist; if your home predates the 1980s or has old plumbing, test.

What matters most, and why

CONTAMINANT	SOURCE	EVIDENCE	FILTER THAT HANDLES IT
Lead	old pipes, solder	no safe level (CDC, WHO); affects fertility in both sexes	certified NSF/ANSI 53 (lead) or reverse osmosis (58)
PFAS ("forever chemicals")	nonstick, stain repellents, industrial	longer time to pregnancy (Fei et al., <i>Human Reproduction</i>); EPA limits now enforceable	RO (58), or carbon block certified for PFAS
Nitrates	agricultural runoff (wells)	EPA limit	RO
Disinfection by-products, chlorine	water treatment	taste; some by-products regulated	activated carbon (42/53)
Pesticides	runoff	see Training 2	carbon block (53) / RO

Filter decision table

FILTER	REMOVES	COST	NOTES
Certified carbon pitcher	chlorine, taste, some VOCs; lead if certified 53	low	replace cartridge on schedule; a pitcher without certification is a jug
Under-sink carbon block	the above plus many pesticides and some PFAS (check listing)	medium	dedicated tap; lasts months
Reverse osmosis	PFAS, nitrates, lead, arsenic, fluoride, most contaminants	higher	wastes some water; removes minerals (choose remineralising stage; keep eating mineral-rich vegetables); the choice if your report shows PFAS or nitrates
Whole-house / shower	chlorine for skin comfort	optional	not a fertility priority
Bottled water	—	high	often filtered tap in plastic; not the answer

Certifications: NSF/ANSI **42** (taste/chlorine) · **53** (lead and named contaminants) · **58** (reverse osmosis)
 · look for the specific contaminant on the listing.

Air

DO	DON'T
Ventilate: 10 min cross-breeze daily; extractor on when cooking (especially gas)	ionising/ozone-producing "purifiers" (ozone is a lung irritant)
True HEPA purifier in the bedroom , sized to the room, carbon layer for VOCs, on low all night	rely on houseplants: hundreds per m ² would be needed to match opening a window (Cummins & Waring, <i>J Exposure Science & Environmental Epidemiology</i>)
Humidity 30–50% (cheap hygrometer)	idle the car in an attached garage; store paint/solvents indoors
Air dry-cleaned clothes and new furniture/mattresses before they come in; low-VOC paint, well before trying	smoke indoors or in the car

Evidence: air-pollution spikes ↔ higher risk of pregnancy loss (Leiser et al., *Fertility and Sterility*); WHO air-quality guidelines; EPA: indoor air 2–5× outdoor pollutant levels.

Research one filter (40 XP)

My water report shows: _____ (date read: _____)

Filter I researched: _____ Type: ☐ pitcher ☐ under-sink ☐ RO ☐ purifier Certification(s):
_____ Cost: _____ Cartridge life: _____

Verdict: _____

Implement one change (30 XP)

☐ Certified pitcher on the counter ☐ Under-sink filter ☐ RO ☐ Bedroom HEPA purifier ☐ Daily 10-minute ventilation habit ☐ Extractor when cooking ☐ Radon test ordered ☐ Other: _____

Date implemented: _____

Setup and maintenance checklist

- ☐ Filter matches what the report shows
- ☐ Certification confirmed on the packaging/listing
- ☐ Cartridge replacement date written on the filter and in the calendar (a filter past its life can release what it collected)
- ☐ Purifier sized to the bedroom; filter change date noted
- ☐ Glass or stainless bottle for carrying water
- ☐ Priority if money is tight: free steps (report, ventilation, shoes off, extractor) → certified pitcher → bedroom HEPA → RO only if needed

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.